

Most digital cameras today allow you to compensate the exposure by 1 to 2 exposure values, plus or minus, in $1/3$ or $1/2$ increments. Generally, positive exposure settings are ideal for scenes that are predominantly bright and negative exposure settings for subjects in which large parts of the scene are really dark. For this, a little deft use of the histogram utility would go a long way.

Histograms

The histogram feature in your camera can be really helpful, especially when trying to arrive at the ideal exposure for a shot with ambiguous lighting.



Histograms give you peaks and valleys of light and dark

The histogram is a straightforward graph that shows you bright and dark areas of the picture. This is displayed from darkest to brightest (left to right) on the horizontal axis. The y-axis displays how much of the image is found at a particular level of brightness. The histogram is usually split into



This histogram shows that very little of the photograph is in the (preferable) middle range